

How is my M.Sci. Project Marked?

Below, are the marking guidelines for supervisors/assessors of projects. How this general guidance will translate to a particular project will vary from project to project. Your supervisor will say how the assessment of your project fits the rough guidelines, and will tell you what he/she is looking for in your project.

Knowledge and Understanding (30%)

Mark: choose... [\[Help\]](#)

[Click to add comment \(Compulsory if the mark is above an A \[75%\] or is below D/E \[40%\]\)](#)

Intended Learning Outcomes being assessed: 30%

1. Demonstrate substantial new knowledge acquired for the direct purpose of developing their project;
2. Demonstrate an awareness of current research pertaining to their project.

Marking guidelines:

- A – Much has had to be learned and the student has achieved a comprehensive grasp of this new knowledge. The student has also shown an excellent understanding of the research methods used.
- B – The student has had to learn a reasonable amount of new material and has shown a satisfactory understanding of the research methods undertaken.
- C – Some new learning has been undertaken though the student has a limited grasp of all aspects of the subject area. The knowledge of research methods is adequate but does not extend beyond the immediate methods used.
- D – A limited amount of new learning has been acquired with a limited understanding of the research methods used.
- E – The student has shown little or no new knowledge over that of a BSc final year student and has only a superficial knowledge of research methods.

Computing Related Cognitive Abilities (30%)

Mark: choose... [\[Help\]](#)

[Click to add comment \(Compulsory if the mark is above an A \[75%\] or is below D/E \[40%\]\)](#)

Intended Learning Outcomes being assessed: 30%

1. Demonstrate the ability to analyse a complex field of work and determine their contribution to the research in that field;
2. Demonstrate a knowledge of the research methods applicable to their field of investigation;
3. Demonstrate originality and innovation in their project work such that the results could contribute towards a publication.

Marking guidelines:

- A – The student has fully analysed the field and has a clear understanding of the original contribution the project makes to research in this field. It would be straightforward to submit a publication based on solely the report.
- B – The student has analysed the field and has some understanding of an original contribution the project would make. A publication could be derived from this report if supplemented with some extra material.
- C – The student has analysed the field but has a limited understanding of an original contribution the project would make. A publication could be derived from this report if supplemented with significant extra material.
- D – The student's analysis of the field is limited. The contribution of the project to the research field is limited and lacks originality. A publication may be possible based on this report but only with a lot of work and if supplemented with significant extra material
- E – The student's analysis of the research field is limited and there is little or no contribution the project makes. A publication based on the report is very unlikely to be successful.

Computing Related Practical Abilities (30%)

Mark: choose... [\[Help\]](#)

[Click to add comment \(Compulsory if the mark is above an A \[75%\] or is below D/E \[40%\]\)](#)

Intended Learning Outcomes being assessed: 30%

1. Analyse/specify/plan/design/implement/test/evaluate a system or hypothesis in support of a research project.
2. Evaluate the project in terms of the quality of the output and methods used, and its contribution to the field of research.
3. Demonstrate effective use of tools and methods to solve a problem and contribute to the research involved.
4. Demonstrate the application of substantial new knowledge acquired during the project for the solution of a relevant problem.

Marking guidelines:

- A – The project is very well planned and executed, drawing on much new knowledge obtained during the project. A significant contribution to research achieved and evaluated.
- B – The project is mostly well planned and executed, drawing on some new knowledge obtained during the project. Some contribution to research has been achieved which could be significant if supplemented with some extra material.
- C – The project has been carried out adequately based on some new knowledge acquired during the project. A minor contribution to research has been achieved which has been partially evaluated.
- D – The project has been completed but has required only a minor addition to BSc level knowledge. The contribution to research has been identified but is mediocre.
- E – The project has been left incomplete or is complete but lacks any originality and required insignificant new knowledge. A contribution to research is difficult to identify.

Additional Transferable Skills (10%)

Mark: choose... [\[Help\]](#)

[Click to add comment \(Compulsory if the mark is above an A \[75%\] or is below D/E \[40%\]\)](#)

Intended Learning Outcomes being assessed:

1. Demonstrate a knowledge of research methods.
2. Employ effective information-retrieval skills (from such sources as libraries, catalogues and the Internet) for the purposes of research and in support of the decision making process;
3. Write a systematic structured report or dissertation including a substantial review of the literature in a research field.

Marking guidelines:

- A – The student has produced a good research report with a comprehensive literature review and detailed research methodology section. The report is comprehensive, coherent and well structured showing good knowledge of the research field.
- B – The report has an extensive literature review, though it is descriptive in parts rather than analytical. The research methodology is described and there is evidence of knowledge of the research field.
- C – The report has a literature review, though it tends to be too descriptive and is less than extensive. The research methodology is described, but the detail and justifications lack depth. There is evidence of knowledge of the research field but it too is descriptive and shows no great understanding.
- D – The report has a limited literature review which is generally too descriptive. The research methodology is described, but the detail and justifications lack depth. There is evidence of knowledge of the research field but it too is descriptive and shows limited understanding.
- E – The report has little more than a BSc report. The literature review is superficial and there is little or no research methodology described. There is little evidence of any new knowledge in any research field.

Overall Mark and Comment

Total calculated mark: